

CASE ID: 202206710713

EPISODE NAME: China bans Taiwanese grouper

2022/06/10 - 2023/12/22

Sender: China (710)

Target: Taiwan (713)

Issue: Contain Political Influence (1)

Final Outcome: Capitulation by Sender after Imposition (8)

Narrative:

On 2022/06/10, China abruptly banned imports of Taiwanese grouper fish, citing the discovery of banned chemicals and oxytetracycline in the aquaculture products.¹

Taiwanese officials claimed that the ban was part of a series of efforts to pressure the island after the election of the Democratic Progressive Party's candidate Tsai Ing-wen, a staunch China critic, in 2016.² The restrictions were consequential, as 91% of grouper exports (upwards of \$50 million per year) went to China.³

The grouper ban was lifted on 2023/12/22.⁴ Chinese officials claimed exports could restart because Taiwanese industry representatives had visited China and provided "rectification information."⁵ However, Taiwan claimed the Chinese government never coordinated with the island's officials and actually lifted the ban in an effort to divide farmers on positions towards China immediately prior to the 2023/01 elections.⁶

¹ Chung, Lawrence. "Beijing's ban on Taiwanese grouper imports prompts emergency measures to help island's fish farmers." *South China Morning Post*, 13 June 2022. <https://www.scmp.com/news/china/politics/article/3181521/beijings-ban-taiwanese-grouper-imports-prompts-emergency>

² *Ibid.*

³ Chang Chien, Amy. "First Pineapples, Now Fish: To Pressure Taiwan, China Flexes Economic Muscle." *New York Times*, 22 June 2022. <https://www.nytimes.com/2022/06/22/business/china-taiwan-grouper-ban.html>

⁴ "China lifts ban on Taiwanese grouper fish imports in carrot and stick diplomacy." Reuters, 22 December 2022. <https://www.reuters.com/world/asia-pacific/china-lifts-ban-taiwanese-grouper-fish-imports-carrot-stick-diplomacy-2023-12-22/>.

⁵ *Ibid.*

⁶ *Ibid.*